

film festival Moving Memory

India's film heritage may leave a lot to be desired—a recording of Mahatma Gandhi's last moments cannot be traced, neither can films such as Ketan Mehta's *Bhavni Bhavai*—but the ongoing International Film Festival of Goa hopes to institutionalise motion picture memory in India with a new permanent section called IFFI Goa Film Treasures. This classics section, backed by the Thomson Foundation for Film and TV Heritage, in conjunction



Chaplin's *Modern Times* with the National Film Archive of India, La Cinematheque Francaise and Film and Television Institute of India, has free-

dom as its theme this year and will be shown at Goa's INOX multiplex between November 27 and December 1. The films include Charlie Chaplin's *Modern Times* (1936), Jean Renoir's *The Grand Illusion* (1937) and Ernst Lubitsch's *To Be or Not To Be* (1942). "There is no such thing as an old film," says Thomson Foundation's managing director Severine Wemaere, who hopes to kick off a restoration drive. "What is shocking is that there's no such thing as a mandatory deposit for filmmakers in India," says Wemaere.

by Kaverie Bamzai

recommendations Colours of Life

MUMBAI Each time a group of artists exhibits together, the audience tends to assume that the works of will have a common strain. The themes, colours, styles or even the angst—we desperately look for a unifying factor. So, when we encounter a cross section of abstract artists that have nothing but abstraction in common, we are, to say the least, perplexed.

The Abstract Tableau is one such exhibition where there is no chorus of voices with an agenda. Each of the exhibiting artists, Vasant Whankhede, Akhilesh Verma, Smriti Dixit, Sheetal Gattani, Sanjay Sawant, Prakash Waghmare and Kiyomi Talaular, has worked on an independent programme. Gallery Art & Soul presents this exhibition of works, till December 12.

by Swati Mathur



Canvas art by Smriti Dixit

BANGALORE Jazz music, devotional music, classical music, Kannada sugama sangeetha and English theatre will be a part of the big annual do, be-

Sunanda Sharma



tween November 30 and December 9 at Bengaluru Habba. The jazz music festival will be from December 2 to 6 at Grand Ashok hotel with Gerard Machado, Suburban Jazz Ensemble, Brown Indian Band and Jazz Junction, the finale being violinist L. Subraman-

yam at the Palace Grounds and fusion bands Pentagonam and Bandish. Musicians Sunanda Sharma, Rashid Khan, Venkatesh Kumar, Shaunak Abhisheki will also be performing.

by Stephen David

DELHI Bini Roy's exhibition The Hope Flowers is a diversely poignant, yet thematically convergent array of paintings inspired by the poems of Lorna Goodison. The strokes have firm roots in nature and are sure to mesmerise aficionados. On till November 27. At Lalit Kala Akademi.

music reviews Truly Tranquil



Music Today
Rs 199

AADAB ARZ HAI
Ghazals are the best poetic forms of expression. This

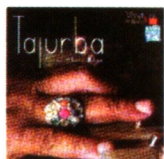
album is a compilation of seven ghazals by Jagjit Singh, Farida Khanum, Ghulam Ali, Mehdi Hasan, Chhaya Ganguli, Iqbal Bano and Abida Parveen. Ganguli's *Yaro mujhe muaf rakho* is a must-hear. What a pity her sensuous and melodious voice isn't used by music directors too often. Definitely, a collector's album.



EMI
Rs 295

KARUNA
As is known, Jagjit Singh is a versatile singer, as he can sing any-

thing from ghazals and classical compositions to bhajans. Name any bhajan, he has sung it all—mantras to stutis. In this album, he sings Krishna bhajans written by Kavi Narayan Agrawal. Unlike his earlier compositions, he has given a new treatment to the bhajans by adding a lot more choral voices. And it works.



Mystica Music
Rs 195

TAJURBA
The harmonium belongs to the wind family of instruments. It was

imported from the West, where harmoniums with both foot and hand-operated bellows could be found. It replaced the sarangi as an accompanying instrument for classical musicians. In this album, Ustad Bhure Khan from Patiala gharana plays ragas Chandrakaus, Bhairavi and Pahari in his unique style.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit